Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 10 9 3
♥ A 10 8 4
♦ Q 10 3
♣ A 9

♠ Q J 6
♥ J 6 2
♦ 8 6
♣ K Q 7 4 2

♠ 8 5 4 2
♥ Q 7 5 3
♦ A 5 2
♣ 6 3

♠ A 7
♥ K 9
♦ K J 9 7 4
♣ J 10 8 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	Pass	3♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♥3

You have great ♦ support and perhaps 15 points. The "perhaps" is because partner may have only 3 ♦s, and if you are the long-trump hand any ruffs you take will probably not increase the number of trump tricks your side makes. But still, you have a great hand.

So you bid 3♦. Partner now says 3NT.

You described your hand very well with your first bid. Partner heard the description and chose 3NT. Since you trust your partner you pass.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 7 4 2 ♥ J 8 6 2 ♦ K J 7 6 ♣ 4 3	
♠ A K 6 3 ♥ K 9 ♦ A 8 3 ♣ Q 9 7 5		♠ J 9 8 5 ♥ Q 7 4 ♦ 10 5 ♣ K 8 6 2
	♠ Q 10 ♥ A 10 5 3 ♦ Q 9 4 2 ♣ A J 10	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♣	Pass	1♠	Pass
3♠			
All Pass			

3♠ by East
Lead: ♦4

You must make a weak response, and in theory there are 3 weak responses you could make with this hand. You could bid 2♣, 1♠ or 1NT. And while none of them would be actually incorrect the best choice is to show your 4-card Major.

You bid 1♠. Partner jumps to 3♠.

You started with just 6 points, and after discovering the ♠ fit you revalue all the way up to 7 points. Partner has shown 16-18 and that's still not enough for game. You pass.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 9 3
♥ A 10 8 3
♦ K Q J 6
♣ Q J

♠ K J
♥ 5 4 2
♦ 8 4 3 2
♣ A K 4 3

♠ Q 10 7 6 5 2
♥ J 6
♦ 9 7
♣ 9 7 5

♠ 8 4
♥ K Q 9 7
♦ A 10 5
♣ 10 8 6 2

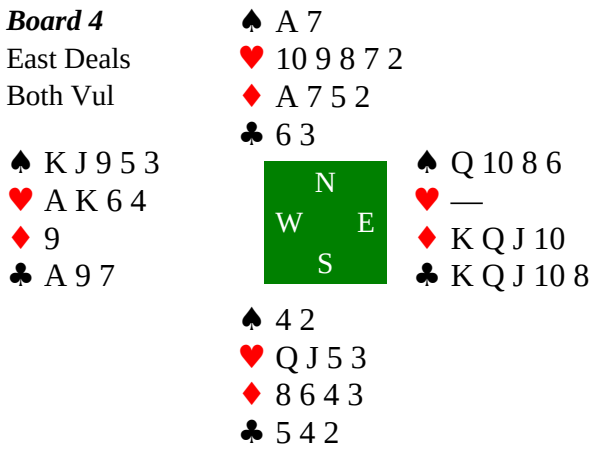
West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♣K

Your top priority as responder is to show a Major suit if you have one, so you say 1♥. Partner jumps to 3♥.

Partner knows you may have only 6 points and went to the 3-level anyway. He is inviting you to bid game if you have a bit more than the 6 you promised. You revalue up to 10 so you have quite a bit more. You accept his invitation and bid 4♥.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♣	Pass
1♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]	Pass
5♠			
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces

5♠ by West
Lead: ♣6

You have a very big hand. But there is no need to start jumping before you know whether you have a fit. So just bid 1♠, partner cannot pass this bid.

Partner now surprises you with a jump to 3♠!.

Wow! Partner has 16 and you have more than that. Slam appears certain, by why not check for Aces? So you bid 4NT and partner answers 5♣. What do you say next?

You probably say "Oh Darn!" or perhaps something less printable. But then you just sign of at 5♠.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ 9 ♥ A K 8 ♦ A J 10 6 4 ♣ K Q J 2	
♠ A 5 3 2 ♥ Q J 10 6 3 2 ♦ 8 ♣ 6 3		♠ Q J 8 7 4 ♥ 9 4 ♦ 7 2 ♣ A 10 8 5
	♠ K 10 6 ♥ 7 5 ♦ K Q 9 5 3 ♣ 9 7 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	Pass	2♦
Pass	4♦	Pass	5♦
All Pass			

5♦ by North
Lead: ♠Q

That is great support, but always remember when supporting a Minor that partner might have only 3 of them. So you bid 2♦. Partner jumps to 4♦.

You were cautious with your first bid, but that is over now. Partner didn't open with a 3-card suit, he really has ♦s. He bypassed 3NT in a flash, so he has no interest in playing anywhere but a ♦ contract. He invites you to bid game if you have something extra above the 6 points you already promised. You have a lot more than that, so you bid 5♦.